Year 3 Admission Assessment v3.1: assessor instructions

Version 3.1, October 2026. Same content as version 1. Use with `Y03/Y03_Student_Booklet_v3.1`; do not mix versions.

Reusable: print once and keep in the assessor's folder. Do not write on these pages. Record each candidate's marks on their own **grading sheet** (`Y03_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`), reading on the **Reading front sheet** and the interview on the **Interview sheet**.

Who this is for. Children applying for Year 3 are usually 7 years old on 1 September. A child from a Chinese mainstream school has usually **completed Grade 1** (一年级): numbers to 100, adding and subtracting within 100, o'clock and half past, yuan and jiao, and simple 2D and 3D shapes. Times tables, division, fractions, cm rulers and time to five minutes usually come later. English as a school subject often starts in Grade 3, so many children have only had English classes outside school; children from bilingual schools may be close to fluent.

How it works. About 55 minutes of tasks, 1:1, plus a welcome and a short break. The child works in the **Student booklet** (11 pages); you lead every task and record the results on the child's grading sheet, Reading front sheet and Interview sheet. Reading uses the shared reading screens. Mark everything the same day and follow Section 5 (Recording the results), which ends with the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`).

1. At a glance

	Task	Minutes	Who leads	Student booklet	You need
1	Welcome and picture talk (speaking)	2 + 4	Assessor, 1:1	page 1	Section 3.1 of these instructions
2	Listening: follow instructions	5	Assessor, 1:1	page 2	Pencil; coloured pencils: red, yellow, blue, green
3	Early Reading Screen, then Graded Sentence Reading Screen	12	Assessor, 1:1	(shared cards)	Shared cards, Early Reading Screen record sheets and Reading front sheet (instructions in `shared/Early_Reading_Screen_Guide` and `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`); a plain card; the levelled reading books
	Break	3 to 5			Water; a chance to move
4	Maths: Section A (number problems) and Section B (word problems and pictures)	18	Child writes; you read any question on request	pages 3 to 10	Pencil, rubber, ruler marked in cm
5	Writing: the picture story	8	Child writes	page 11	Pencil
6	Short interview and goodbye	8	Assessor, 1:1		Interviewer guide (`forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y3_Y4`) and Interview sheet (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y3_Y4`); paper and crayons
	Total	**about 55**, plus welcome and break			

What to print

For each candidate:

- the Student booklet (A4, single-sided, at actual size; colour if possible, but the emoji pictures are clear in greyscale)
- the grading sheet (`Y03/Y03_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`)
- the Reading front sheet (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`)
- the Interview sheet (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y3_Y4`)
- the parent conversation record (`forms/Parent_Conversation_Record`)
- the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`), completed after the visit
- the Early Reading Screen record sheets (`shared/Early_Reading_Screen_Record`): only the sheets you expect to use

For the room (print once, laminate the cards):

- these instructions
- the Interviewer guide (`forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y3_Y4`)
- the Sentence Reading Guide (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`)
- the laminated Graded Sentence Reading Screen card (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`)
- the laminated Early Reading Screen cards (`shared/Early_Reading_Screen_Cards`) and guide (`shared/Early_Reading_Screen_Guide`)
- the levelled reading books
- the equipment in the "You need" column of the table above

2. Before you start

The room. Quiet and bright, with a low table. Sit beside the child, not opposite. Keep the door open or another adult present. Have the booklet open at page 1 and everything else out of sight.

Pace of speech. Year 3 students are still learning English: speak slowly and clearly, about 120 words a minute, with a pause after each sentence. Use the same pace for every candidate, so that the results can be compared (do not slow down further for a child who finds it hard, and repeat an instruction only where these instructions allow it). The listening recording is paced the same way.

Say: "Hello, [name]. My name is [your name]. I am a teacher here. Today we are going to look at some pictures, listen, read, do some maths and do some writing. Some things are easy and some are hard. That is fine. Just do your best. You can ask me to say things again."

Write the child's name on page 1 if they cannot.

Access rules (the same in every year group)

	English tasks: picture talk, listening, reading screens, writing	**Maths**
Reading aloud	Say only what the script says. Do not explain words, translate, or read the reading texts for the child. You may repeat an instruction in English.	Read any question aloud in English, as often as the child asks, and point to the picture.
Chinese	Not used by staff.	If a Chinese-speaking colleague is present and the child cannot follow the English after it has been read aloud, the colleague may say the question once in Chinese. Write **L** by the question and list it on the grading sheet. The mark still counts.
Answers	In English only. An answer in Chinese scores 0.	In English only: numbers, words, ticks, drawings and working all count. An answer or explanation in Chinese scores 0.

Codes. NT not yet taught: the child says they have not learnt it; it scores 0 and is listed on the grading sheet. **L** language support in maths. **R** a listening instruction repeated. Record extra time, a reader or any other access arrangement for a known need on the grading sheet. Wherever these instructions say "note it", write the note in the comment space on the grading sheet.

Keeping the child at ease. Chat for a minute first. Praise effort ("Thank you", "You are working hard"), never right or wrong answers. Do not mark in front of the child. Any child may stop a task when they have done what they can. If the child is upset, tired or very quiet, take a break or stop, and record it on the grading sheet. Never press a distressed child.

3. English

3.1 Speaking: picture talk (4 minutes, booklet page 1)

Say: "Look at these pictures. They tell a story. The girl is Mei. This is her grandpa. Let's talk about the pictures."

The story (for you, not to read aloud): 1. Mei and Grandpa plant a seed in a flower pot. 2. Mei waters the pot and a small plant comes up. 3. It is a very hot day; the plant droops and Mei is sad; Grandpa brings the watering can. 4. The plant has grown into a sunflower taller than Mei; they are happy.

Ask the prompts in order, slowly and clearly (see **Pace of speech** in Section 2). Wait about 5 seconds before you move on. You may point to a picture, but do not name things for the child and do not correct their English. Record what the child says on the grading sheet, as exactly as you can.

Step	Say (and point)	Listen for
1 Name	"What can you see?" Point to things: "What is this?"	Single words: sun, flower, pot, seed, plant, water, girl, grandpa; watering can, sunflower
2 Describe	Picture 2: "What is Mei doing?"	"Water"; "She is watering the plant."
3 Feelings and why	Picture 3: "How does Mei feel? Why?"	"Sad"; "because the plant is ill / dying / too hot / needs water"
4 Tell the story	"Now tell me the whole story. Start here." Point to picture 1.	The events in order; then, and, because; past tense (planted, watered, grew); time words (every day, one day, at the end)
5 Predict and connect	"What do you think Mei will do next?" Then: "Do you have plants or flowers at home? Tell me about them."	An idea of their own; talk about their own life

Speaking guide for this task. Use it together with the interview. The speaking band is given on the Interview sheet.

Band	At this age, in this task
A New to English	Silent, points, or names one or two things; may talk in Chinese.
B Early acquisition	Names many things; short phrases ("girl sad", "flower big"); needs the prompts.
C Developing competence	Simple sentences with errors ("She put seed in pot. The flower is grow big."); tells the story with help.
D Competent	Tells the whole story in connected sentences, with some past tense; says why; occasional errors.
E Fluent	Tells the story easily, as a fluent English-speaking 7 year old would: past tense, linking words, feelings, an idea about what happens next.

3.2 Listening: follow instructions (about 5 minutes with the recording, booklet page 2)

Recording. A recording of this test is in `audio/v3.1/Y03/` (see its `READ_ME_FIRST.txt` for the tracks and timings). Play it instead of reading the script: every candidate then hears the same voices, pace and pauses. The script below is its transcript, and the live reading option if no recording can be played. Do not pause the recording during a reading of the script.

You need: the park picture (page 2), a pencil, and four coloured pencils (red, yellow, blue, green) on the table.

Say: "Look at this picture. I am going to tell you what to do. Listen carefully, then do it. Sometimes you point with your finger. Sometimes you use your pencil."

How to give it

- Say each instruction **once**, slowly and clearly, about 120 words a minute with a pause after each sentence (see **Pace of speech** in Section 2). Do not point to, look at or gesture towards anything in the picture.
- If the child asks, or does nothing for about 5 seconds, say it **once more** and tick **R** on the grading sheet.
- With the recording, if the child asks, or clearly did not hear, pause, go back to the start of the item (the start times are in the read-me) and play it once more: tick **R** on the grading sheet. Pause the recording while a child is still working on an item.
- Score **1** if the child does everything in the instruction correctly, after the first or the second hearing. Otherwise score **0**. Say "Thank you" after every item, whatever happens.
- **Practice (not scored):** "Point to the cloud." If needed, show the child by pointing yourself, then say it again.
- **Stop** if the child scores 0 on three items in a row. Say: "Well done. That is the end of the listening."

No.	Type	Say exactly	Score 1 if the child
1	One step	"Point to the house."	Points to the house.
2	One step	"Point to the boat."	Points to the boat on the pond.
3	One step	"Draw a circle round the bike."	Draws a ring round the bike (a rough ring is fine).
4	Position: under	"Point to the ball under the bench."	Points to the ball under the bench, not the ball on the seat.
5	Position: next to	"Draw a circle round the cat next to the house."	Rings the cat on the grass next to the house, not the cat in the tree.
6	Position: between	"Point to the bird between the two trees."	Points to the flying bird between the trees, not the bird on the roof.
7	Two steps	"Draw a sun in the sky. Then put a cross on the bench."	Does both: a sun anywhere in the sky (a circle is enough) and a cross on the bench.
8	Two steps	"Colour the big duck yellow, and draw a circle round the small duck."	Does both: some yellow on the big duck (another colour scores 0) and a ring round the small duck.
9	Sequence: before	"Before you draw a circle round the house, draw a line under the boat."	Draws the line under the boat **first**, then rings the house. Watch the order.
10	Condition: if	"Look at the pond. If there are three ducks, draw a fish in the water. If there are not three ducks, draw a flower next to the bench."	Draws a flower next to the bench (either side) and no fish. There are two ducks.

Total: 10 marks (1 for each item).

Band guide: 0 to 2 **A**; 3 to 4 **B**; 5 to 6 **C**; 7 to 8 **D**; 9 to 10 **E**.

What to look for

- Choosing the other ball, cat or bird in items 4 to 6 means the position word (under, next to, between) is not yet known, although the noun is.
- Doing only the last part of items 7 and 8, or doing item 9 in the order heard (house first), is typical of a child whose English is still developing (band C): short instructions are understood, longer ones cannot yet be held in English.
- Many R ticks with correct answers show understanding that is still slow. A child who watches your face for clues may understand less than the score suggests; note it.

3.3 Reading: the shared reading screens (12 minutes)

Use the Early Reading Screen (`shared/Early_Reading_Screen_Cards` and the record sheets in `shared/Early_Reading_Screen_Record`) with the **Year 3 start point** (Guide, Section 2): start at **Section 1, words 1 to 10** (practice Card 3, then Card 4).

- **If words 1 to 10 are easy** (9 or 10 right, most read without sounding out): skip words 11 to 20 and the letter sounds, and go straight to Section 2. Section 2 is 15 or more: go on to the passages. Section 2 is 12 to 14: the tricky words, then the passages. Section 2 is under 12: go back to words 11 to 20, then the tricky words and the passages.
- **If not:** as Year 2. Finish Section 1 (and Section 2 if Section 1 is 15 or more), then the letter sounds, the tricky words and the passages.

Then give the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`, with the rules in `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide` and the score grid on the Reading front sheet) starting at **Level 2** (sentence 4).

- The instructions for the Early Reading Screen are in `shared/Early_Reading_Screen_Guide`; those for the sentence reading are in `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`. Follow their scoring and stopping rules. These instructions have no reading task of their own.
- In Years 1 to 3 the **reading band** comes from the Early Reading Screen; the sentence reading screen confirms it (see the Sentence Reading Guide, Section 7).
- Pronunciation features common for speakers of Chinese (for example l and r, a light final consonant, an extra vowel at the end of a word) are not reading errors when the word is clearly right.
- Record the reading results on the **Reading front sheet** (the Early Reading Screen summary and the sentence reading results) and give it to the interviewer (Sections 3.5 and 5).

3.4 Writing: the picture story (8 minutes, booklet page 11)

The writing comes after the maths (see Section 1).

Say: "Do you remember the story about Mei and the sunflower? Now write the story. Look at each picture and write about it. Start with 'First'." Point to each frame word and read it once, slowly and clearly: "First ... Then ... Next ... At the end."

- Do not spell words, give vocabulary or correct anything. If the child asks for a spelling, say: "Have a go. Write the sounds you can hear."
- If the child has not started after about a minute, say: "Write a word for each picture." Record "labels" on the grading sheet.
- **Only if the child cannot connect with the pictures at all**, offer a short recount instead: "Write about something you did last weekend." The frame words still help. Record "recount" on the grading sheet.
- Stop after 8 minutes, or earlier when the child has finished.

The four criteria. Score each from 0 to 4; 1 and 3 fall between the descriptions. Total: 16 marks.

Criterion	0	2	4
Content and organisation	No English writing about the pictures, or only the frame words copied.	Writes about two or three of the pictures, in order, in phrases or short sentences.	Tells the whole story in order (all four pictures) with a clear ending, and adds a detail, a feeling or something a character says.
Vocabulary	No English words of the child's own.	Everyday words for the pictures (girl, flower, sun, water, sad, big).	Some precise or interesting words (seed, planted, watering can, hot, thirsty, droopy, grew, tall, taller than).
Grammar and sentences	No sentence.	Simple sentences, often without past tense or "a" and "the" ("She put seed. Flower is big.").	Correct simple sentences, past tense mostly right, some joined with and, but, because, so or when.
Spelling and punctuation	Letters or strings that cannot be read as words.	Common words mostly right; other words spelt as they sound (sunflowr, woterd, gru); some capital letters and full stops.	Most common words right, including common exception words (the, was, said, they); capital letters and full stops nearly always right; perhaps an exclamation mark or a question mark.

Checklist. Tick the writing checklist on the grading sheet (it includes whether the child uses Chinese characters or pinyin).

Writing band (best fit). Read the piece against the band descriptors in `00_Admissions_Guide`, Section 6, and choose the band that fits best. Record the band on the grading sheet. The total is only a guide: about 0 to 3 **A**, 4 to 7 **B**, 8 to 10 **C**, 11 to 13 **D**, 14 to 16 **E**.

What band E looks like at this age. About five or more sentences that tell the whole story in order, mostly in the past tense, joined with words such as and, then, because and when; capital letters and full stops nearly every time; common words spelt correctly and harder words spelt so that they can be read; perhaps a feeling or a few words of speech. This is what a fluent English-speaking child at the end of UK Year 2 writes.

What to look for

- Missing past tense endings, plurals and "a" and "the" are normal for a learner of English: judge what the child can communicate.
- Spelling that uses pinyin letter values (for example "xi" for "she") shows the child is using sounds they know. Note it: it helps the teacher.
- Very slow, effortful handwriting, or letter formation that is also weak in Chinese (ask the parents), may point to a fine motor need. Note it on the Interview sheet.

3.5 Short interview and goodbye (8 minutes)

The questions are in `forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y3_Y4` and the record is the Interview sheet (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y3_Y4`). In Year 3 the sentence reading has already been done with the Early Reading Screen (Section 3.3), so do not repeat it in the interview. Choose about two questions from each block. Give the **speaking band** on the Interview sheet, using the picture talk (Section 3.1) and the interview together, and complete the suitability strands. To finish, thank the child and tell them one thing they did well. Do not give any results.

4. Maths (18 minutes, booklet pages 3 to 10)

Say: "Now we are going to do some maths. You can write in the booklet. I can read any question to you. Just ask me." Show the child Section A (number problems) and Section B (word problems and pictures).

- **Equipment:** pencil, rubber, ruler marked in cm. No calculator and no counters: the child may draw, or count on the pictures.
- **Reading aloud:** read any question in English as often as the child asks, slowly and clearly (see **Pace of speech** in Section 2), and point to the picture. Offer to read the word problems (Questions 7, 8 and 13) if the child does not ask. The Chinese reading is once only, by a colleague, after the English: write **L** (and list it on the grading sheet).

- **Time:** about 5 minutes for Section A and 13 minutes for Section B. If the child is stuck for about a minute, say: "Have a go, or we can go on to the next one." If they say they have not learnt something, write **NT** (and list it on the grading sheet).
- Questions 5 and 6b are Year 3 content, there to find the ceiling. A Year 3 entrant is not expected to get them.

Mark scheme. One mark for each answer unless the table says otherwise. Type: **N** number problem, **W** word problem, **P** problem with a picture or diagram.

Q	Type	Answer	Also accept	Notes: common errors; may not have been taught	Marks
				Section A: Number problems	
1	N	14; 12		Floor questions: Chinese Grade 1 work.	2
2	N	59; 45			2
3	N	83; 35		713 or 73 for the first: carrying not secure. 45 for the second: takes the smaller digit from the larger in each column (7 – 2 = 5).	2
4	N	20; 9		Multiplication and division may not have been taught (Chinese Grade 2). A child may still work them out by counting.	2
5	N	377		Year 3 content. Numbers above 100 may not have been taught (Grade 2).	1
				Section B: Word problems and pictures	
6	P	a 53; b 246		a: 35 (tens and ones swapped); 8 (counted the pieces). b: 200406 or 20046 (wrote each part) shows the parts are known but not place value. b is Year 3 content; numbers above 100 may not have been taught. Base 10 pictures may be new: Chinese classes use bundles of sticks and counting frames.	2
7	W	23	23 stickers	47 (added). Crossing out 12 stars and counting the rest is a good method.	1
8	W	20	20 dumplings	Counting every dumpling is fine. 9 (added 4 and 5) suggests the question was not understood: read it again. Multiplication may not have been taught.	1
9	P	7 cm	7	Centimetres and rulers may not have been taught (Grade 2).	1
10	P	6 sides and 6 vertices		Both needed for the mark. If the word "vertices" is the problem, say "corners": this is maths vocabulary, not a trick.	1
11	P	a 7; b 2		b: 8 (added 5 and 3) means "how many more" was not understood: a common English barrier. Read it again.	2
12	P	a half past 7; b twenty-five past 9	a 7:30, 7.30, seven thirty; b 9:25, 9.25, 25 past 9	a: 6:35 (hands swapped) or 8:30 (took the next number for the hour). b: 5:45 (hands swapped). Time to five minutes may not have been taught (Grade 2).	2
13	W	a ¥20; b ¥5	20, 20 yuan, 20元; 5, 5 yuan	b: 35 (added).	2
14	P	A straight vertical line through the tip of the arrow and the middle of the bottom edge	A freehand line, if it is clearly meant to be straight and goes through both points (within about 3 mm)	A horizontal line, or any other line, scores 0. Lines of symmetry may not have been taught (Grade 2).	1
15	P	a C only; b $^3/_4$	b: three quarters; 3 out of 4; 四分之三 (write L)	a: B (did not check that the parts are equal) or D (2 parts shaded). b: $^1/_4$ or $^4/_3$. Fractions may not have been taught (Grade 3).	2

Total: 24 marks (Section A, Questions 1 to 5: 9 marks; Section B, Questions 6 to 15: 15 marks), of which word problems (Questions 7, 8, 13a and 13b): 4 marks.

Band guide (provisional, to be reviewed after the first 20 to 30 candidates): 0 to 9 **1** Well below expected; 10 to 14 **2** Working towards; 15 to 20 **3** Expected; 21 to 24 **4** Greater depth. List the NT questions on the grading sheet. If they explain a low score, judge whether the child would reach band 3 once taught.

Number problems and word problems. Compare Questions 1 to 3 (adding and subtracting with no words) with Questions 7 and 13 (the same skills in words). A child who does well on number problems but poorly on word problems may have an English barrier rather than a maths difficulty: check by reading the word problem aloud (and, if a Chinese-speaking colleague is present, once in Chinese, marked L).

What to look for

- **Strong:** quick, accurate calculation; uses the pictures sensibly (crossing out stickers, counting the plates in fives); checks answers.
- **A maths difficulty:** errors on Questions 1 to 3 as well as on the word problems; counts in ones for everything; cannot read the ruler or the clock even when the question is read aloud.
- **An English barrier:** right answers to the number problems, but wrong or blank word problems that become right when read aloud or said in Chinese; asks for many questions to be read.

Likely not yet taught for a child who has completed Chinese Grade 1: Questions 4 and 8 (multiplication and division), 5 and 6b (numbers above 100), 9 (centimetre ruler), 12b (time to five minutes), 14 (symmetry) and 15 (fractions). Children from bilingual schools, or who have started Grade 2, may have met some of these.

5. Recording the results

1. Mark the student booklet the same day (every maths question has a mark box).
2. Copy the totals onto the grading sheet and give the bands from the band guides above (the grading sheet repeats them at a glance).
3. Record the reading results and band on the Reading front sheet (the reading band comes from the Early Reading Screen; the sentence reading confirms it).
4. Give the interviewer the Reading front sheet and the Interview sheet before the interview.
5. After the interview, put together the grading sheet, Reading front sheet, Interview sheet and parent conversation record, and complete the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`) within two working days.
6. File the marked student booklet with them (or shred it under the school's policy).